



How to prompt Claude on this project

A short, practical cheat sheet built from how our sessions have gone. Copy any prompt and edit the bits in bold.

DESIGN

Design iteration (mockups first)

I'll build up to 3 side-by-side mockups if you ask for options. Keep saying "give me three" until you're happy — I won't touch the real site until you say so.

"I want to redesign the header. Show me three mockups — don't touch the code yet."

"Same again but remove the search box and make the wordmark bigger."

"Do the same but for desktop, at a laptop width."

"That's it — use B, build it into the site." — **this is the go-live trigger**

Tips that work: send a screenshot and say "like this style but change X"; reference by number ("like #2 but with the burger from #1"); speak in feelings, not code ("tighter", "hug the corner", "same baseline").

BUILD

Wiring a mockup into the site

Once we've picked a mockup, this is the go-ahead.

"Use P5-C. Build it into the site and deploy."

"Build B2 but keep the mobile version we shipped."

"Wire it up but don't deploy yet — I want to see it running first."

DEPLOY

Deploying to production

The main branch is what Vercel serves. I'll never merge to main without you asking.

"Deploy." · "Push it live." · "Merge to main."

"Deploy but only after X works."

"Don't deploy yet, just push to the branch." — **keeps it staging-only**

COPY

Content & copy changes

Small edits, wording tweaks — quick to do, easy to phrase.

"Change the tagline from NEWS · DATA · SPORTS to X."

"Update the top story to be about X."

"Rewrite the newsletter blurb — shorter and punchier."

DATA Adding a data source (seed → live)

The pattern that works: name the thing, hint at the source, tell me what to fall back to.

“Make the JSE page live. Use EOD Historical Data if it’s cheap enough, otherwise recommend a source. Fall back to sample data if the API key is missing.”

“Replace the news seed with Marketaux live headlines. Cache for 10 minutes so we don’t burn the quota.”

“Wire the calendar to a live feed — recommend a good one first.”

If you don’t know which source to use, just ask: “What’s the best free source for X?” — I’ll compare 2–3 and recommend one.

FEATURE Adding a new page or section

“Add a new page called Bonds at /bonds. Coming-soon placeholder for now, styled like the others.”

“Add a Top Movers section to the NYSE page — show the 5 biggest gainers and losers.”

“Add a crypto watchlist to the Crypto page. Users can pin coins, saved in local storage.”

FIX Fixing something that broke

Send a screenshot when something looks wrong — it saves me 5 minutes of guessing.

“The desktop wordmark is truncated. Fix and redeploy.”

“The Subscribe button isn’t working on my iPhone — check it.”

“The build is failing — what broke, and fix it.”

STYLE Adjusting how I explain things

I’ll explain briefly as we build (your preference). Nudge deeper or shorter whenever.

“Go deeper on FormSubmit — how does it work, what are the risks?”

“What am I paying for at scale here?”

“Just do it — skip the explanation.”

“Sanity check — anything I’m missing before we ship?”

STATUS Status updates & briefers

“Give me a branded PDF with what’s working and what’s not.” — [this doc’s sibling](#)

“What’s on the roadmap? Rank them by impact.”

“What would you ship this week if it were up to you?”

STYLE + SPEED GUARDRAILS (SET ONCE, FOLLOW ALL DAY)

“Keep answers short — no essays.”

“Only do what I ask — don’t refactor extras.”

"Ask before doing anything destructive."

"Show me the change before you commit."

THE MAGIC WORDS

"Give me three" → mockups instead of code

"Deploy" → merge to main and push

"Don't deploy yet" → keep it on the feature branch

"Go deeper" / "Just do it" → adjust explanation depth

"Show me" → screenshot, mockup or dry-run first

THINGS THAT DON'T WORK WELL

Vague asks with no examples. "Make it better" → I'll ask what "better" means. Send a screenshot, name a site you like, or point to the specific bit.

Multiple unrelated tasks in one message. Split them — easier to track and undo.

Assuming I remember old sessions. Each conversation starts fresh. If we discussed something last week, paste the key bit back in.

Skipping the mockup step for big design changes. Jumping straight to code usually means we redo it. Mockups first, then wire it in.